



TRG Academic Year 2026–27

Organisation, meetings, seminars and group resources



**Academic activities commence in the week beginning
Monday 28 of Sep 2026**

Cristina Trujillo Research Group

Department of Chemistry | The University of Manchester

[TRG website](#) • [TRG GitHub](#)

1. Welcome and purpose

This document brings together the main practical information for the Trujillo Research Group (TRG) during the 2026–27 academic year, including the weekly schedule, group membership, seminar coordination, communication channels and onboarding information for new members.

The TRG Guidelines for Conduct remain the main place to check practical expectations around communication, meetings, preparation, deadlines, working arrangements and raising concerns. New members should read the guidance available through the TRG GitHub repository. The main idea is simple: we work respectfully, keep each other updated, and deal with issues early rather than letting them grow.

2. TRG members

Core TRG students

Listed by academic seniority and stage of study.

Student	Email	2026–27 note
Diana Bura	burad@tcd.ie	Expected submission: December 2026
Tim Renningholtz	tim.renningholtz@manchester.ac.uk	Expected submission: December 2026
James O'Brien	james.obrien-4@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	Expected submission: March 2027. Website and GitHub
Christian Malavasi	christian.malavasi@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	Seminar Coordinator; Brainstorm Session Chair
Shukriya Saher	shukriya.saher@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	Starts 1 October 2026

Shared PhD students and Postdoc

These colleagues are linked to TRG activities, while their main research home is the group shown below.

Main group	Member	Email	Role / note
Andrew Leach Group	Nikeel Cull	nikeel.cull@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	Shared PhD student
Andrew Leach Group	Mauno Lius	mauno.lius@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	Shared PhD student; expected submission March 2027
Michael James Group	Jonathan Da Luz	jonathan.daluz@manchester.ac.uk	Postdoc experimental + computational

Main group	Member	Email	Role / note
Michael James Group	Darragh O'Brien	darragh.obrien@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	PhD student; experimental + computational
Giacomo Crisenza Group	Sara Bellini	sara.bellini@postgrad.manchester.ac.uk	PhD student; experimental + computational
Armando Carlone Group	Jonathan Di Pietro	jonathan.dipietro@student.manchester.ac.uk	PhD student; experimental + computational

3. At-a-glance weekly group dynamic

Note: 1:1 meetings will resume in the week beginning 28 September 2026.

Day	Time	Activity
Monday	09:00	1:1 meeting with Christian
Tuesday	09:00–10:00	TRG research group meeting and coffee, Seminar Room 3.027
Wednesday	09:00	1:1 meeting with Jonathan DL
Wednesday	10:00	1:1 meeting with James
Thursday	10:00	1:1 meeting with Jonathan DP
Thursday	15:00–16:00	Weekly TRG group seminar, Seminar Room 3.027
Friday	Flexible	Research and writing time; additional meetings by arrangement

4. Tuesday research group meeting and coffee

Every Tuesday, 09:00–10:00, Seminar Room 3.027, starting 29 Sep 2026.

The Tuesday meeting is our main weekly space to discuss science, publications, conferences, opportunities and group matters.

The first Tuesday meeting on 29 September will be used to agree the seminar plan for the year. The weekly seminars will probably start in the week beginning 12 October 2026.

Usually attending	Welcome when useful
James	Tim
Christian	Diana
Shukriya	Nik
Jonathan DP	Mauno
Jonathan DL	Darragh
	Sara

5. Weekly group seminars

Every Thursday, 15:00–16:00, Seminar Room 3.027, starting in the week beginning 12 October 2026.

Christian will coordinate the weekly seminars.

Attendance: James, Christian, Shukriya and Jonathan DP are expected to attend. Tim, Diana, Jonathan DL, Nik, Mauno, Darragh and Sara are welcome to attend when useful. Matas, Ali and Yixin are also welcome when the topic is relevant, as associated collaborators rather than TRG members.

Maintain the seminar calendar and coordinate speakers.

Circulate seminar information and materials.

Organise practical arrangements.

I will keep an eye on the overall scientific direction, but the detailed seminar topics will be discussed with the students during the year, rather than fixed too rigidly in advance.

Semester 1

Will focus on theory-based seminars. We will agree the specific topics together, with enough structure to be useful but enough flexibility to adapt as the year develops.

Semester 2

Research-based seminar programme, including research updates and related scientific discussion.

6. Monthly brainstorm sessions

First Friday of each month | Chair: Christian

These are informal sessions, separate from the group seminars, where we can discuss research ideas, scientific difficulties, collaborations, publications, conferences, career development and ways of improving how the group works.

7. Communication and online presence

Slack

TRG uses Slack for day-to-day group communication, announcements, opportunities and seminar information. Students, shared students, postdoctoral researchers and associated researchers who would like to join can let Cristina know so they can be added.

Website and GitHub

Coordinator: James

Maintain the TRG website.

Maintain the TRG GitHub organisation and repositories.

Coordinate updates to member profiles and online group information.

Website: trujilloresearchgroup.com

GitHub: [Trujillo-Group organisation](https://github.com/Trujillo-Group)

New-member onboarding

New students, postdoctoral researchers, visitors and associated researchers should provide the following information so that the group website, GitHub and Slack spaces can be kept up to date.

Provide James with a professional photograph.

Provide a short biography and a brief description of research interests for the group website.

Ask Cristina to be added to the TRG Slack workspace, if they would like access.

Read the TRG guidance and relevant resources in the GitHub repository before starting research activities.

8. Group guidance and expectations

The general idea is simple: be respectful, come prepared, keep people updated, and flag problems early rather than letting them grow. Scientific disagreement is completely fine, and often useful, as long as we keep the discussion constructive.

Key principle

Different opinions are welcome, and good science often needs them. The important thing is that discussion stays constructive, professional and focused on finding a way forward.

9. Key responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Cristina	I will look after the overall scientific direction and individual supervision.
Christian	Seminar coordination and monthly brainstorm sessions.
James	TRG website and GitHub coordination.
All members	Come prepared, communicate clearly, keep people updated, and contribute to discussions constructively.